

Social Awareness Assessment

15 questions across 3 dimensions, with a scoring guide and development suggestions for each area.

How to Complete This Assessment

- Rate yourself honestly on each statement from 1 (Never) to 5 (Always), based on your actual observed behavior, not your intentions
- Think of specific recent situations as you answer, rather than a general impression of yourself
- This measures noticing and reading social information — not what you do with it afterward, which is a related but separate skill

The Three Awareness Dimensions

Dimension	What It Covers
Reading Social Cues	Noticing non-verbal signals, tone, and emotional undertones in a conversation as they happen
Understanding Group Dynamics	Recognizing how a group or team actually functions beneath its stated structure and norms
Organisational Awareness	Reading the broader organizational climate, politics, and unwritten rules beyond the official process

The Assessment

Rate each statement: 1 (Never) – 2 (Rarely) – 3 (Sometimes) – 4 (Often) – 5 (Always)

Reading Social Cues (Questions 1-5)

1. I notice when someone's tone doesn't match their words, even if they don't say anything is wrong. ____
2. I pick up on body language cues (crossed arms, avoided eye contact) without needing them pointed out. ____
3. I can tell when a room's mood has shifted, even if no one has said why. ____
4. I notice when someone is uncomfortable in a conversation before they say so directly. ____
5. I can sense hesitation in someone's response, even when they ultimately agree out loud. ____

Understanding Group Dynamics (Questions 6-10)

6. I can identify who actually holds influence in a group, separate from formal titles. ____
7. I notice when a group's stated norms don't match how it actually behaves. ____
8. I can sense when a team is quietly divided, even if the disagreement hasn't surfaced openly. ____
9. I notice patterns in who speaks, who gets interrupted, and who stays quiet in group settings. ____
10. I can tell when a group decision is genuine consensus versus quiet, unspoken disagreement. ____

Organisational Awareness (Questions 11-15)

11. I understand how decisions actually get made in my organization, beyond the official process. ____
12. I'm aware of which relationships and alliances matter for getting things done here. ____
13. I notice shifts in organizational priorities before they're formally announced. ____
14. I understand the unwritten rules of my organization's culture, not just its stated values. ____
15. I can read how a proposal is likely to be received by different stakeholders before I present it. ____

Scoring Guide

Add your scores for each dimension's 5 questions, then find the corresponding band below. Score each dimension separately — a single overall number hides which specific area needs attention.

Dimension	Questions	Max Score	Developing (below 60%)	Solid (60-80%)	Strength (above 80%)
Reading Social Cues	1-5	25	Below 15	15-19	20-25
Understanding Group Dynamics	6-10	25	Below 15	15-19	20-25
Organisational Awareness	11-15	25	Below 15	15-19	20-25

A “Developing” score in one dimension while others are strong is common — social awareness isn’t one undifferentiated skill, and reading individual cues well doesn’t guarantee reading organizational politics well, or vice versa.

Development Suggestions

If Reading Social Cues scored Developing

- Before responding in a conversation, pause and ask yourself what the other person's tone and body language are telling you, separate from their words
- Practice naming what you observe, tentatively, in low-stakes conversations (“You seem a little hesitant about that — am I reading that right?”) to calibrate your accuracy
- Watch a recorded meeting or conversation with the sound off first, then with sound, and compare what you picked up on each pass

If Understanding Group Dynamics scored Developing

- In your next few meetings, deliberately track who speaks, who gets interrupted, and who stays quiet — patterns are often invisible until you're actively looking for them
- After a group decision, ask privately: “Was that genuine agreement, or did people just stop objecting?”
- Notice the gap between a team's stated norms (what's said in onboarding or values documents) and what actually happens day to day

If Organisational Awareness scored Developing

- Before a significant proposal, ask a trusted, more politically attuned colleague how they think different stakeholders will actually react
- Pay attention to what actually gets rewarded and promoted in your organization, not just what's officially valued in writing
- Notice which relationships seem to make things move faster when someone needs something — that's a signal about where real influence sits

Revisit this assessment in 2-3 months after deliberately practicing one or two of the suggestions above — social awareness develops through active, deliberate noticing, not through a single reading of a development tip.